

Word family: **fabric / fabrics / fabricate / fabricated / fabricating / fabrication / fabricator / prefabricate / prefabricated / prefabrication**

Base word: fabric

Part of speech: mainly **noun**

Related forms and lexical relatives:

* **fabric** (n.) — 布料；織物；結構；組織

* **fabrics** (plural n.) — 各類布料 / 織物

* **fabricate** (v.) — 製造；組裝；捏造

* **fabricated** (adj./participle) — 製造的；組裝的；捏造的

* **fabrication** (n.) — 製造；加工；捏造；虛構故事

* **fabricator** (n.) — 製造商 / 加工者；捏造者

* **prefabricate** (v.) — 預製

* **prefabricated / prefab** (adj.) — 預製的

* **prefabrication** (n.) — 預製；預製工法

Important family note: **fabricate / fabrication** are historically and lexically related to **fabric**, but their modern meanings have become quite independent. For learners, they are worth keeping in the wider family while **not assuming every meaning of fabric transfers directly to fabricate**.

Major useful extensions:

feel the fabric, fabric type, fabric choice, fabric composition, fabric content, fabric quality, fabric texture, fabric colour, fabric sample, fabric swatch, fabric roll, fabric store, fabric care, fabric care label, fabric softener, fabric conditioner, fabric dye, fabric paint, fabric glue, fabric scissors, fabric weight, fabric width, fabric grain, natural fabric, synthetic fabric, cotton fabric, wool fabric, silk fabric, linen fabric, stretch fabric, breathable fabric, waterproof fabric, water-resistant fabric, lightweight/heavyweight fabric, woven fabric, knitted fabric, non-woven fabric, upholstery fabric, technical fabric, performance fabric, recycled fabric, fabric damage, fabric shrinks/stretches/fades/pills, social fabric, fabric of society, cultural fabric, economic fabric, institutional fabric, urban fabric, building fabric, historic fabric, fabric of reality, fabric of space-time/spacetime, rock fabric, geological fabric, network fabric, data fabric, storage fabric, computing fabric, fabricate a component, fabricate steel, fabricate a structure, fabricate evidence, fabricate a story, fabricated claim, fabrication process, metal fabrication, digital fabrication, prefabricated building, prefabricated components.

Meaning in this passage

> Unlike shoppers in a physical boutique, our customers cannot try on a dress, **feel the fabric** or compare two sizes in front of a mirror.

Here, **fabric** means:

the cloth or textile material from which a garment is made — 布料；衣料；織物

The customer cannot physically touch the item before buying, so they cannot judge things such as:

- * softness,
- * thickness,
- * stretch,
- * weight,
- * breathability,
- * stiffness,
- * drape,
- * comfort.

中文翻譯：

與在實體精品店購物的顧客不同，我們的顧客不能試穿裙子、**親手感受布料**，或在鏡子前比較兩個尺碼。

So here:

feel the fabric = 親手觸摸衣服的布料，以判斷其質感、厚薄、柔軟度等

A. FABRIC = CLOTH / TEXTILE MATERIAL

1. **fabric = cloth used to make clothing or other textile products — 布料；織物**

This is the **exact passage sense**.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> Customers cannot **feel the fabric** before ordering.

顧客下單前不能**親手感受布料**。

Practice 2

> The dress is made from a soft, lightweight **fabric**.

這條裙由柔軟而輕盈的**布料**製成。

Practice 3

> Different fabrics behave differently after washing.

不同**布料**清洗後的表現不同。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****fabric = 用紗線、纖維等製成，可用來做衣服、窗簾、家具等的布料 / 織物****

2. ****feel the fabric — 觸摸 / 感受布料****

Especially important in your passage.

Practice 1

> Many customers want to ****feel the fabric**** before buying expensive clothing.

很多顧客購買昂貴服裝前都想先****摸一摸布料****。

Practice 2

> Photos cannot tell you exactly how the fabric feels.

單靠照片不能準確知道****布料摸起來的感覺****。

Here ****feel**** concerns tactile qualities such as:

* soft / rough,

* smooth,

* thick / thin,

* stiff,

* stretchy.

3. ****a fabric = a particular type of cloth — 一種布料****

****Fabric**** can be countable when talking about different types.

Practice 1

> This ****fabric**** is suitable for summer clothing.

這種****布料****適合夏季服裝。

Practice 2

> We tested several different ****fabrics****.

我們測試了幾種不同的**布料**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****a fabric = 某一特定種類、結構或成分的布料****

B. FABRIC TYPE / COMPOSITION

4. **fabric type — 布料種類**

Practice 1

> The website should state the **fabric type** clearly.

網站應清楚列明**布料種類**。

Practice 2

> Different fabric types require different care.

不同**布料種類**需要不同保養方式。

5. **fabric composition — 布料成分**

A major fashion/retail expression.

Practice 1

> Check the **fabric composition** before washing the garment.

洗衣前先查看**布料成分**。

Practice 2

> The product page lists the fabric composition as 95% cotton and 5% elastane.

產品頁列明**布料成分**為 95% 棉和 5% 彈性纖維。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****fabric composition = 一塊布由哪些纖維以及各自多少比例構成****

6. **fabric content — 布料纖維成分**

Practice 1

> The label gives the **fabric content**.

標籤列出了**布料纖維成分**。

Practice 2

> Fabric content can affect stretch and care requirements.

布料成分會影響彈性和保養要求。

7. **fabric quality — 布料品質**

Practice 1

> Customers complained about the **fabric quality**.

顧客投訴**布料品質**。

Practice 2

> Fabric quality cannot always be judged accurately from photographs.

單靠照片未必能準確判斷**布料質素**。

8. **fabric choice — 布料選擇**

Practice 1

> The **fabric choice** affects how the dress hangs.

布料選擇會影響裙子的垂墜效果。

Practice 2

> Good fabric choice is important in clothing design.

選擇合適的**布料**對服裝設計很重要。

C. FABRIC SAMPLE / SWATCH

9. **fabric sample — 布料樣本**

Practice 1

> The supplier sent us a **fabric sample**.

供應商寄來一塊**布料樣本**。

Practice 2

> Customers cannot inspect a fabric sample when shopping from a normal product page.

網購顧客一般不能親自查看**布料樣本**。

10. **fabric swatch — 布辦；小塊布樣**

A very common fashion/interior-design term.

Practice 1

> The designer compared several **fabric swatches**.

設計師比較了數塊**布辦 / 布料樣本**。

Practice 2

> Fabric swatches help customers compare colour and texture.

布料樣本有助顧客比較顏色和質感。

MCQ-ready definition:

fabric swatch = 用來展示布料顏色、質感或成分的一小塊樣布

11. **fabric roll / roll of fabric — 一卷布**

Practice 1

> The workshop received ten **rolls of fabric**.

工場收到十**卷布**。

Practice 2

> The fabric is sold by the metre from the roll.

布料從整卷中按米出售。

D. NATURAL / SYNTHETIC FABRICS

12. **natural fabric — 天然纖維布料**

Practice 1

> Cotton and linen are commonly used in **natural-fibre fabrics**.

棉和麻常用於**天然纖維布料**。

Practice 2

> Some customers prefer natural fabrics.

有些顧客較喜歡**天然布料**。

13. **synthetic fabric — 合成纖維布料**

Practice 1

> Polyester is widely used in **synthetic fabrics**.

聚酯纖維廣泛用於**合成布料**。

Practice 2

> Synthetic fabrics may have very different properties from natural fabrics.

合成布料的特性可能與天然布料很不同。

14. **cotton fabric — 棉布**

Practice 1

> The shirt is made from breathable **cotton fabric**.

襯衫由透氣的**棉布**製成。

Practice 2

> Cotton fabric can shrink if washed incorrectly.

棉布如果清洗不當可能縮水。

15. **wool fabric — 羊毛布料**

Practice 1

> The coat uses heavy **wool fabric**.

這件外套使用厚重的**羊毛布料**。

Practice 2

> Wool fabrics require appropriate care.

羊毛布料需要適當護理。

16. **silk fabric — 絲質布料**

Practice 1

> The dress uses delicate **silk fabric**.

裙子使用細緻的**絲質布料**。

Practice 2

> Silk fabric can have a very different feel from polyester.

絲質布料摸起來可以與聚酯纖維非常不同。

17. **linen fabric — 麻布**

Practice 1

> Linen fabric is popular for summer clothing.

麻布常用於夏季服裝。

Practice 2

> This linen fabric wrinkles easily.

這種**麻布**很容易皺。

E. WOVEN / KNITTED / NON-WOVEN

18. **woven fabric — 梭織布；機織布**

Practice 1

> The trousers are made from a strong **woven fabric**.

長褲採用堅韌的**梭織布**製成。

Practice 2

> Woven fabrics are constructed by interlacing yarn systems.

梭織布是由紗線交織形成的。

19. **knitted fabric — 針織布**

Practice 1

> T-shirts are often made from **knitted fabric**.

T恤常用**針織布**製成。

Practice 2

> Knitted fabrics can offer more stretch than many woven fabrics.

****針織布****通常比很多梭織布更有彈性。

20. ****non-woven fabric — 不織布；非織造布****

Practice 1

> Some disposable products use ****non-woven fabric****.

部分即棄產品使用****不織布****。

Practice 2

> Non-woven fabric is made without conventional weaving or knitting.

****不織布****並非用傳統編織或針織方式製成。

Important distinction 1: ****woven vs knitted****

****woven****

typically formed by interlacing two yarn directions.

****knitted****

formed through interconnected loops.

This can affect:

- * stretch,
- * drape,
- * structure,
- * fit.

Very relevant to online clothing.

F. FABRIC PROPERTIES

21. ****stretch fabric — 彈性布料****

Practice 1

> The jeans use a **stretch fabric**.

牛仔褲使用**彈性布料**。

Practice 2

> Stretch fabric can make sizing more forgiving.

彈性布料可以令尺碼適應性較高。

22. **breathable fabric — 透氣布料**

Practice 1

> Customers often prefer **breathable fabrics** in summer.

夏天顧客往往較喜歡**透氣布料**。

Practice 2

> Breathable fabric can improve comfort.

透氣布料可以提升舒適度。

23. **waterproof fabric — 防水布料**

Practice 1

> The jacket is made from **waterproof fabric**.

外套使用**防水布料**製成。

Practice 2

> Waterproof fabric is designed to prevent water passing through under specified conditions.

防水布料旨在特定條件下阻止水滲透。

24. **water-resistant fabric** — 抗水 / 防潑水布料

Practice 1

> The bag uses **water-resistant fabric**.

手袋使用**防潑水布料**。

Practice 2

> Water-resistant does not necessarily mean fully waterproof.

抗水 / 防潑水並不一定等於完全防水。

Important distinction 2: **waterproof vs water-resistant**

waterproof

designed to resist water penetration to a substantially higher specified level.

water-resistant

resists some water but may not prevent penetration under prolonged/heavy exposure.

Do not automatically translate both as exactly the same 「防水」.

25. **lightweight fabric** — 輕薄布料

Practice 1

> The blouse uses a **lightweight fabric**.

這件襯衫使用**輕薄布料**。

Practice 2

> Lightweight fabrics may suit warmer weather.

輕薄布料可能較適合炎熱天氣。

26. **heavyweight fabric — 厚重布料**

Practice 1

> The coat is made from a **heavyweight fabric**.

外套使用**厚重布料**製成。

Practice 2

> Fabric weight affects the drape and warmth of a garment.

布料重量會影響衣物的垂墜感和保暖度。

27. **fabric weight — 布重；布料重量**

Practice 1

> The product description should include the **fabric weight** where relevant.

在適當情況下，產品描述應列明**布料重量**。

Practice 2

> Two fabrics with the same fibre composition can have different weights.

即使纖維成分相同，兩種布料的**重量 / 厚重感**也可能不同。

28. **fabric width — 布幅；布料寬度**

Practice 1

> Fabric is sold in several standard **widths**.

布料有不同標準**布幅**。

Practice 2

> Fabric width affects how much material is needed.

布幅會影響所需用料量。

G. FABRIC BEHAVIOUR

29. **fabric stretches — 布料有彈性 / 會拉伸**

Practice 1

> This fabric **stretches considerably**.

這種布料**彈性很大**。

Practice 2

> Customers may choose a different size depending on how much the fabric stretches.

顧客可能會視乎布料的**伸展程度**選擇不同尺碼。

30. **fabric shrinks — 布料縮水**

Practice 1

> The fabric may **shrink after washing**.

布料清洗後可能**縮水**。

Practice 2

> Pre-washing can reveal how much a fabric shrinks.

預洗可以看出布料會**縮水多少**。

31. **fabric fades — 布料褪色**

Practice 1

> Dark fabrics may **fade** over time.

深色布料日久可能**褪色**。

Practice 2

> The customer complained that the fabric faded after one wash.

顧客投訴布料洗一次後便**褪色**。

32. **fabric pills / pilling — 布料起毛粒**

Practice 1

> The fabric began to **pill** after repeated wear.

布料多次穿着後開始**起毛粒**。

Practice 2

> Fabric pilling can affect appearance.

布料起毛粒會影響外觀。

MCQ-ready definition:

pilling = 布料表面因摩擦形成細小纖維球的現象

33. **fabric wrinkles/creases — 布料起皺**

Practice 1

> This fabric **wrinkles easily**.

這種布料很容易**起皺**。

Practice 2

> Fabric behaviour after washing should be described accurately.

產品資料應準確說明布料清洗後的**表現**。

H. FABRIC CARE

34. **fabric care — 布料護理；衣料保養**

Practice 1

> Follow the ****fabric-care instructions****.

遵守****布料護理指示****。

Practice 2

> Different fabrics require different care methods.

不同布料需要不同****保養方法****。

35. ****fabric care label — 布料 / 衣物洗滌護理標籤****

Practice 1

> Read the ****fabric care label**** before washing.

洗衣前先看****護理標籤****。

Practice 2

> Care labels explain washing and drying requirements.

****護理標籤****會說明清洗及乾燥要求。

36. ****fabric softener — 衣物柔順劑****

A major everyday compound.

Practice 1

> Do not use ****fabric softener**** on this garment.

這件衣服不要使用****衣物柔順劑****。

Practice 2

> Fabric softener can affect some technical fabrics.

****衣物柔順劑****可能影響某些功能性布料。

37. **fabric conditioner — 衣物柔順劑**

Especially common in BrE.

Practice 1

> Add a small amount of **fabric conditioner**.

加入少量**衣物柔順劑**。

Practice 2

> “Fabric softener” and “fabric conditioner” overlap strongly.

fabric softener 和 **fabric conditioner** 基本上指相近產品。

I. FABRIC DYE / PAINT / GLUE

38. **fabric dye — 布料染料**

Practice 1

> Use a suitable **fabric dye**.

使用合適的**布料染料**。

Practice 2

> The dye is designed for natural fabrics.

這種染料是為天然布料而設。

39. **fabric paint — 布料顏料**

Practice 1

> She decorated the bag with **fabric paint**.

她用**布料顏料**裝飾手袋。

Practice 2

> Fabric paint remains flexible after drying.

****布料顏料**乾後仍具有一定柔韌性。**

40. ****fabric glue — 布藝膠 / 布料膠水****

Practice 1

> Use ****fabric glue**** for the small repair.

這次小修補可使用****布料膠水****。

Practice 2

> Fabric glue is designed to bond textile materials.

****布藝膠****是為黏合紡織材料而設。

41. ****fabric scissors — 布剪 / 裁布剪****

Practice 1

> Use sharp ****fabric scissors****.

使用鋒利的****裁布剪****。

Practice 2

> Fabric scissors should not be used for paper if you want to keep them sharp.

如果想保持鋒利，****裁布剪****最好不要用來剪紙。

J. UPHOLSTERY / INTERIOR FABRIC

42. ****upholstery fabric — 家具布；椅墊面料****

Practice 1

> The sofa is covered in durable **upholstery fabric**.

梳化使用耐用的**家具布料**包覆。

Practice 2

> Upholstery fabrics are designed for heavier wear than many clothing fabrics.

家具布通常比很多服裝布料更耐磨。

43. **curtain fabric — 窗簾布**

Practice 1

> She chose a heavy **curtain fabric**.

她選了一種厚重的**窗簾布**。

Practice 2

> The fabric blocks much of the light.

這種布料能阻擋大量光線。

K. TECHNICAL / PERFORMANCE FABRIC

44. **technical fabric / technical textile — 技術性布料；產業用紡織品**

Practice 1

> The jacket uses a **technical fabric** designed for outdoor activity.

外套採用為戶外活動而設的**功能性技術布料**。

Practice 2

> Technical fabrics may be designed for strength, protection or moisture management.

技術性布料可能特別設計以提供強度、防護或排汗功能。

45. **performance fabric — 功能性布料**

Practice 1

> Sportswear often uses **performance fabrics**.

運動服常使用**功能性布料**。

Practice 2

> Performance fabrics may stretch, dry quickly or manage moisture.

功能性布料可能具有彈性、快乾或排濕特性。

46. **recycled fabric — 再生布料**

Practice 1

> The collection uses **recycled fabrics**.

這個系列採用**再生布料**。

Practice 2

> Recycled fabric can be made from several recovered fibre sources.

再生布料可以使用不同回收纖維來源製造。

Important distinction 3: **fabric vs fibre**

fibre

basic strand/material:

* cotton fibre,

* polyester fibre.

fabric

sheet/material produced from fibres/yarns.

Roughly:

> fibre → yarn → fabric → garment

although actual manufacturing routes vary.

So:

> cotton = fibre/material

> cotton fabric = cloth made using cotton fibres.

Important distinction 4: ****fabric vs yarn****

****yarn****

continuous thread-like material used to:

- * weave,
- * knit,
- * produce textiles.

****fabric****

the broader sheet/material produced.

Do not translate both simply as 「布料」.

L. FABRIC VS CLOTH

Important distinction 5: ****fabric vs cloth****

They overlap heavily, but:

****fabric****

more technical/general and especially common when discussing:

- * type,
- * composition,
- * properties,
- * garment manufacture.

****cloth****

more everyday and may emphasize a piece/material of cloth.

- > fabric composition

- > very natural

- > *cloth composition*

- > less natural in fashion labelling.

- > a cleaning cloth

- > 抹布

Here **cloth** has a meaning **fabric** does not normally replace.

Important distinction 6: **fabric vs material**

You already curated **material**, so keeping the distinction clean:

material

extremely broad:

- * wood,

- * metal,

- * plastic,

- * leather,

- * fabric, etc.

fabric

specifically textile-like material.

Therefore:

- > fabric is a type of material.

But:

- > metal is a material, not a fabric

except in specialized metaphorical/engineered expressions.

Important distinction 7: ****fabric vs textile****

****textile****

broader technical/industrial concept:

- * fibres,
- * yarns,
- * cloth,
- * textile products/industry.

****fabric****

usually the actual sheet-like cloth material.

- > textile industry
- > 紡織業

- > fabric of a blouse
- > 襯衫布料

In ordinary fashion English, ****fabric**** is often more natural when discussing a garment itself.

M. FABRIC = BASIC STRUCTURE OF SOMETHING

47. ****fabric = underlying structure or framework — 結構；組織****

A major figurative branch.

Practice 1

- > Trust is part of the ****fabric of a healthy organisation****.

信任是健康機構****基本結構 / 組織的一部分****。

Practice 2

- > Technology has changed the fabric of everyday life.

科技改變了日常生活的****基本結構****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****fabric = 構成某個社會、制度、文化或生活方式的基本結構和相互關係****

The metaphor is:

> individual threads woven together → one fabric.

N. THE FABRIC OF SOCIETY

48. **the fabric of society — 社會結構；社會肌理**

A major fixed metaphor.

Practice 1

> Trust helps hold together the **fabric of society**.

信任有助維繫**社會結構**。

Practice 2

> Severe inequality can weaken the social fabric.

嚴重不平等可能削弱**社會的基本聯繫和結構**。

MCQ-ready definition:

the fabric of society = 把社會成員、制度、關係和共同規範連結起來的整體結構

49. **social fabric — 社會結構；社會網絡 / 肌理**

Practice 1

> Community organisations strengthen the **social fabric**.

社區組織可以強化**社會結構和人際聯繫**。

Practice 2

> Conflict can damage the social fabric.

衝突可能破壞**社會凝聚結構**。

50. **tear at the social fabric — 撕裂社會結構**

Practice 1

> Long-term distrust can **tear at the social fabric**.

長期不信任可能**撕裂社會關係結構**。

Practice 2

> The metaphor treats social relationships like woven cloth.

這個比喻把社會關係想像成**編織在一起的布**。

O. CULTURAL / ECONOMIC / INSTITUTIONAL FABRIC

51. **cultural fabric — 文化結構；文化肌理**

Practice 1

> Small shops are part of the district's **cultural fabric**.

小店是該區**文化肌理**的一部分。

Practice 2

> Migration can reshape a city's cultural fabric.

人口遷移可以重塑城市的**文化結構**。

52. **economic fabric — 經濟結構**

Practice 1

> Small businesses form part of the local **economic fabric**.

小型企業構成本地**經濟結構**的一部分。

Practice 2

> The closure affected the economic fabric of the town.

結業影響了小鎮的**經濟網絡與結構**。

53. **institutional fabric** — 制度結構；機構網絡

Practice 1

> The reforms changed the country's **institutional fabric**.

改革改變了該國的**制度結構**。

Practice 2

> Schools and hospitals form part of a community's institutional fabric.

學校和醫院構成社區**制度網絡**的一部分。

54. **fabric of everyday life** — 日常生活結構

Practice 1

> Smartphones are woven into the **fabric of everyday life**.

智能手機已融入**日常生活的基本結構**。

Practice 2

> Work patterns can become part of the fabric of family life.

工作模式可以成為**家庭生活結構**的一部分。

Important distinction 8: **fabric vs structure in figurative use**

structure

neutral organization of parts.

fabric

adds the metaphor of:

* many interconnected threads,

- * relationships,
- * cohesion.

So:

- > social structure
- > 較分析性
- > social fabric
- > 更強調**人與制度交織而成的整體**

P. URBAN FABRIC

55. **urban fabric — 城市肌理；城市空間結構**

A major architecture/planning term.

Practice 1

- > The development should respect the existing **urban fabric**.

發展項目應尊重原有**城市肌理**。

Practice 2

- > Narrow streets and small blocks shape the urban fabric.

狹窄街道和小型街區塑造了**城市空間結構**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****urban fabric = 城市的街道、建築、地段、公共空間等互相組成的實體空間結構****

56. **historic urban fabric — 歷史城市肌理**

Practice 1

- > The project preserves the **historic urban fabric**.

項目保留了**歷史城市肌理**。

Practice 2

> Large-scale demolition can disrupt historic urban fabric.

大規模拆卸可能破壞**歷史城市空間結構**。

Q. BUILDING FABRIC

57. **building fabric — 建築物本體 / 圍護結構與主要物理構件**

Especially important in BrE architecture/construction.

Practice 1

> Improving insulation reduces heat loss through the **building fabric**.

改善隔熱可以減少熱量經**建築物本體 / 圍護結構**流失。

Practice 2

> Water penetration damaged the historic building fabric.

滲水損害了歷史建築的**實體建築構件**。

MCQ-ready definition:

building fabric = 構成建築物實體本身的牆、屋頂、樓板、窗戶等主要物理部分

58. **historic fabric — 歷史建築原有物料 / 實體構件**

Practice 1

> Repairs should preserve as much **historic fabric** as possible.

維修應盡量保留原有**歷史建築實體 / 原材料**。

Practice 2

> Original timber is part of the building's historic fabric.

原有木材是建築**歷史實體構造**的一部分。

Important distinction 9: **building fabric vs fabric material**

In:

> ****fabric of a dress****

fabric = textile cloth.

In:

> ****building fabric****

fabric = physical construction/body of the building.

No actual textile is implied.

R. FABRIC OF REALITY / SPACETIME

59. ****fabric of reality — 現實的基本結構****

A common metaphorical expression.

Practice 1

> The novel imagines a tear in the ****fabric of reality****.

小說想像現實的****基本結構****出現裂縫。

Practice 2

> “Fabric” here is metaphorical, not textile.

這裡的 ****fabric**** 是「****結構****」的比喻，不是布料。

60. ****fabric of spacetime / space-time — 時空結構 / 時空織體****

Common popular-science metaphor.

Practice 1

> Gravity is often described in popular explanations as curvature in the ****fabric of spacetime****.

科普解釋常把重力描述為****時空結構****的彎曲。

Practice 2

> “Fabric” is a metaphor for the structure of spacetime, not a literal material cloth.

這裡的 ****fabric**** 是描述時空****結構****的比喻，並不是實際布料。

S. GEOLOGY: ROCK FABRIC

61. ****fabric = spatial arrangement/orientation of components in a rock — 岩石結構****

A specialist but established geology sense.

Practice 1

> Geologists examined the ****fabric of the rock****.

地質學家研究岩石的****結構****。

Practice 2

> Mineral alignment can produce a distinct rock fabric.

礦物排列可以形成明顯的****岩石結構****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****rock fabric = 岩石內礦物、顆粒或結構元素的排列、方向和幾何關係****

62. ****geological fabric — 地質結構****

Practice 1

> Deformation changed the ****geological fabric****.

變形作用改變了****地質結構****。

Practice 2

> Fabric analysis can reveal deformation history.

****結構分析****可以幫助了解變形歷史。

This is specialist enough for recognition rather than everyday active use.

T. COMPUTING: NETWORK FABRIC

63. **network fabric** = interconnected network infrastructure — 網絡架構；網絡互連結構

A major modern computing sense.

Practice 1

> The servers are connected through a high-speed **network fabric**.

伺服器透過高速**網絡互連架構**連接。

Practice 2

> A network fabric connects many devices through an integrated topology.

網絡 fabric / 互連架構以整合式拓撲連接大量設備。

MCQ-ready definition:

network fabric = 把伺服器、交換器、儲存裝置等連成整體的互連網絡架構

The metaphor comes naturally from:

> many threads woven into one fabric.

64. **fabric network / switching fabric** — 交換架構；交換網絡

Practice 1

> The switch has a high-capacity **switching fabric**.

交換器具有高容量的**交換架構**。

Practice 2

> The switching fabric moves data between ports.

交換架構負責在不同連接埠之間傳輸數據。

U. STORAGE FABRIC

65. **storage fabric — 儲存網絡架構**

Practice 1

> The servers connect to storage through the **storage fabric**.

伺服器透過**儲存網絡架構**連接儲存設備。

Practice 2

> A storage fabric may connect many storage and compute systems.

儲存 fabric 可以連接多個儲存與運算系統。

V. DATA FABRIC

66. **data fabric — 數據架構 / 資料織網**

A major modern enterprise-data term.

Practice 1

> The company is developing a **data fabric** across its systems.

公司正在各系統之間建立整合的**數據架構**。

Practice 2

> A data fabric aims to make data easier to integrate and access across different environments.

data fabric 的目標是令不同環境中的數據更容易整合和存取。

MCQ-ready definition:

data fabric = 把分散在不同系統、平台和位置的數據以統一方式連接、管理和存取的架構概念

67. **computing fabric — 運算互連架構**

Practice 1

> The system uses a tightly integrated **computing fabric**.

系統使用緊密整合的**運算互連架構**。

Practice 2

> The term emphasizes interconnected computing resources acting as one system.

這個詞強調不同運算資源被連接成一個整體系統。

Important distinction 10: **fabric in computing vs framework**

framework

software/development structure or conceptual structure.

fabric

especially emphasizes:

- * interconnected nodes,
- * networking,
- * integrated infrastructure.

So:

> network fabric

is not simply another word for any software framework.

W. FABRICATE = MANUFACTURE / CONSTRUCT

Now to the related lexical family.

68. **fabricate** = manufacture/build from materials or components — 製造；加工；組裝

Practice 1

> The workshop **fabricates** metal frames.

工場**製造 / 加工**金屬框架。

Practice 2

> The components were fabricated off-site.

這些構件在場外**預先製造加工**。

MCQ-ready definition:

fabricate = 尤其透過切割、加工、焊接、組裝等方式製造實體物件或構件

69. **fabricated component — 加工製成的構件**

Practice 1

> The structure contains several **fabricated steel components**.

結構包含數個**加工製成的鋼構件**。

Practice 2

> Each fabricated component was inspected.

每個**製造構件**都接受檢查。

70. **fabricate steel / metal — 加工鋼材 / 金屬**

Practice 1

> The company **fabricates steel** for construction projects.

公司為建築項目**加工鋼材**。

Practice 2

> Metal can be fabricated into complex shapes.

金屬可以**加工成複雜形狀**。

X. FABRICATION = MANUFACTURING

71. **fabrication = manufacturing/construction process — 製造；加工**

Practice 1

> The parts are sent for ****fabrication****.

零件被送往進行****加工製造****。

Practice 2

> Metal fabrication requires specialised equipment.

****金屬加工製造****需要專門設備。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****fabrication = 把材料加工、組裝成產品或構件的製造過程****

72. ****metal fabrication — 金屬加工****

Practice 1

> The company specialises in ****metal fabrication****.

公司專門從事****金屬加工****。

Practice 2

> Metal fabrication may involve cutting, bending and welding.

****金屬加工****可能包括切割、彎曲和焊接。

73. ****fabrication process — 製造工序****

Practice 1

> The ****fabrication process**** takes several days.

****製造工序****需要數天。

Practice 2

> Quality checks occur throughout fabrication.

整個**製造過程**都會進行品質檢查。

74. **digital fabrication — 數碼製造**

Practice 1

> The laboratory teaches **digital fabrication**.

實驗室教授**數碼製造技術**。

Practice 2

> Digital fabrication can include computer-controlled manufacturing methods.

數碼製造可包括由電腦控制的製造方式。

Y. FABRICATE = INVENT FALSE INFORMATION

75. **fabricate a story = invent it dishonestly — 捏造故事**

A completely different and extremely important verb branch.

Practice 1

> He **fabricated a story** to explain the missing goods.

他**捏造了一個故事**來解釋貨物失蹤。

Practice 2

> The customer was accused of fabricating the complaint.

顧客被指**捏造投訴內容**。

MCQ-ready definition:

fabricate information = 故意創造假的故事、說法或證據，並假裝它是真的

76. **fabricate evidence — 捏造 / 偽造證據**

Practice 1

> Nobody should ****fabricate evidence**** to support a return claim.

任何人都不能為支持退貨申索而****捏造證據****。

Practice 2

> The allegation that evidence had been fabricated was investigated.

有關證據被****捏造 / 偽造****的指控受到調查。

77. ****fabricate an excuse — 編造藉口****

Practice 1

> He ****fabricated an excuse**** for the delay.

他為延誤****編造了一個藉口****。

Practice 2

> The explanation sounded fabricated.

這個解釋聽起來像是****捏造的****。

78. ****fabricated claim/allegation — 捏造的主張 / 指控****

Practice 1

> The company denied the ****fabricated allegation****.

公司否認這項****捏造的指控****。

Practice 2

> Fabricated claims can damage trust.

****捏造的申索 / 主張****會損害信任。

Z. FABRICATION = LIE / INVENTED STORY

79. **a fabrication = invented false story — 捏造；虛構故事；謊言**

Practice 1

> His explanation was a complete **fabrication**.

他的解釋完全是**捏造的故事**。

Practice 2

> The claim turned out to be a fabrication.

結果證明該主張是**虛構 / 捏造的**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****a fabrication = 故意捏造並當成真實內容來說的虛假故事或說法****

Important distinction 11: **fabrication = manufacturing vs fabrication = lie**

Manufacturing:

> metal fabrication

> **金屬加工**

Falsehood:

> his story was a fabrication

> 他的故事是**捏造的**

Same noun, radically different meaning.

AA. FABRICATOR

80. **fabricator = person/company that manufactures components — 加工商；製造商**

Practice 1

> The steel **fabricator** supplied the structural components.

鋼材**加工商**供應結構構件。

Practice 2

> Fabricators turn raw materials into finished components.

****加工製造商****把原料加工成完成構件。

81. ****fabricator = person who invents falsehoods — 捏造者****

Possible but less common than:

> liar

> person who fabricated the story.

Practice 1

> The court found that he was the fabricator of the false documents.

法院認定他是虛假文件的****捏造者****。

For ordinary learners, recognition is enough.

AB. PREFABRICATE / PREFABRICATED

82. ****prefabricate = manufacture components before they reach the final site — 預製****

Practice 1

> The building components were ****prefabricated**** in a factory.

建築構件在工廠中****預製****。

Practice 2

> Prefabrication can reduce on-site construction time.

****預製工法****可以減少現場施工時間。

83. ****prefabricated building — 預製建築****

Practice 1

> The school uses a **prefabricated building**.

學校使用一座**預製建築**。

Practice 2

> Prefabricated buildings are assembled from components made in advance.

預製建築由事先製造的構件組裝而成。

84. **prefabricated component** — **預製構件**

Practice 1

> The site received several **prefabricated components**.

工地收到數個**預製構件**。

Practice 2

> Prefabricated components can improve consistency.

預製構件可以提升製造一致性。

85. **prefab** — **預製式建築 / 預製的**

Informal shortened form.

Practice 1

> The offices were housed in temporary **prefab buildings**.

辦公室設於臨時**預製式建築**內。

Practice 2

> “Prefab” can function as a noun or modifier.

prefab 可以作名詞或前置修飾語使用。

AC. COUNTABILITY OF FABRIC

Important distinction 12: ****fabric can be uncountable or countable****

Uncountable — material generally:

- > The dress uses soft ****fabric****.
- > 裙子使用柔軟****布料****。

Countable — a type of textile:

- > We tested three ****fabrics****.
- > 我們測試了三種****布料****。

Do not automatically think:

- > fabrics = pieces of cloth.

It often means:

different types of fabric.

Important distinction 13: ****a piece of fabric****

When referring to one physical piece rather than one fabric type:

- > ****a piece of fabric****

is often clearest.

Practice

- > She cut a small piece of fabric.

她剪下一小****塊布****。

AD. FABRIC VS TEXTURE

You already curated ****texture****, so the distinction is crucial here.

****fabric****

the actual textile material.

texture

how its surface feels/appears.

> feel the **fabric**

> 摸布料本身

> feel the **texture** of the fabric

> 感受布料的**質感**

A fabric can have:

* smooth texture,

* rough texture,

* soft texture.

So:

fabric ≠ texture.

Important distinction 14: **fabric vs quality**

fabric

what textile material it is.

fabric quality

how good that material is.

Two garments can use the same nominal fabric type but differ considerably in quality.

Important distinction 15: **fabric vs composition**

fabric

finished textile material.

composition

what fibres make it up.

Example:

> fabric = jersey knit

> composition = 95% cotton + 5% elastane

Different kinds of information.

AE. FABRIC VS GARMENT

fabric

material before/within clothing.

garment

finished item of clothing.

> fabric → cut/sewn → garment.

A problem with:

> fabric quality

is different from a problem with:

> garment sizing.

Important distinction 16: **fabric vs clothing**

fabric

textile material.

clothing

finished wearable items collectively.

> buy fabric to make clothing.

AF. FABRIC VS FIBRE — RETAIL LABELS

On a clothing label:

> **100% cotton**

normally identifies fibre composition.

It does not tell you everything about the resulting fabric, because the fabric can differ in:

- * weave/knit,
- * weight,
- * finish,
- * stretch,
- * density.

Therefore:

same fibre ≠ same fabric feel.

This is exactly why **feel the fabric** matters in online shopping.

AG. FABRIC VS FIT — PASSAGE LINK

Your passage gives:

- > cannot try on a dress
- > cannot **feel the fabric**
- > cannot compare sizes.

These represent three distinct uncertainties:

fit

Does the garment physically fit?

fabric

What does the textile material actually feel and behave like?

size comparison

Which labelled size works better?

So **fabric** is not just decorative detail. It can influence:

- * comfort,
- * drape,
- * stretch,
- * warmth,
- * appearance,
- * sizing tolerance.

AH. "FABRIC" IN PRODUCT DESCRIPTIONS

86. **fabric description — 布料描述**

Practice 1

> Product pages should contain accurate **fabric descriptions**.

產品頁應提供準確的**布料描述**。

Practice 2

> "Soft fabric" alone may be too vague.

單寫「柔軟布料」可能過於含糊。

87. **fabric information — 布料資料**

Practice 1

> Better **fabric information** may reduce avoidable returns.

更完整的**布料資料**可能減少可避免的退貨。

Practice 2

> Customers may want to know composition, stretch and weight.

顧客可能想知道布料的成分、彈性和重量。

88. ****fabric description materially different — 布料與描述有重大差異****

This connects to the later refund condition:

> materially different from its description.

Practice 1

> If the fabric is materially different from the description, the customer may have a stronger return case.

如果實際****布料與描述有重大差異****，顧客的退貨理由便更充分。

AI. FABRIC OF SOCIETY VS MATERIAL FABRIC

This is the biggest polysemy jump.

Literal:

> soft cotton fabric

> 柔軟棉布

Figurative:

> social fabric

> 社會結構

The metaphor is based on:

many individual threads woven into one connected whole.

Thus:

> people/institutions = threads

> society = fabric.

AJ. FABRIC IN ARCHITECTURE VS URBAN FABRIC

****building fabric****

physical components of one building.

urban fabric

pattern and physical structure of a wider city/neighbourhood.

Compare:

> repair the building fabric

> 修復建築實體

> preserve the urban fabric

> 保留城市肌理

AK. FABRIC IN COMPUTING VS SOCIAL FABRIC

Both are metaphorical extensions from weaving.

social fabric

people/institutions interconnected.

network fabric

computers/network devices interconnected.

The common semantic core is:

many individual elements woven into an integrated whole

AL. FABRICATE VS MAKE

make

extremely general.

fabricate

in manufacturing:

more technical, often means construct from parts/materials.

> make a chair

> ordinary

> fabricate a steel frame
> technical manufacturing

Important distinction 17: ****fabricate vs manufacture****

****manufacture****

produce goods, often at industrial scale.

****fabricate****

construct/form a component or structure from materials, often by:

- * cutting,
- * shaping,
- * welding,
- * assembling.

They overlap, but:

> steel fabrication
> is particularly natural.

Important distinction 18: ****fabricate vs assemble****

****assemble****

join already-made parts together.

****fabricate****

can include making/shaping the parts themselves as well as assembling them.

AM. FABRICATE = LIE VS INVENT

****invent a story****

can be innocent/creative:

> invent a bedtime story.

fabricate a story

usually implies deliberate deception:

> invent a false story and present it as true.

So:

fabricate = strongly negative in information contexts.

Important distinction 19: **fabricate vs fake**

fabricate evidence

create false evidence.

fake evidence

can mean create/manipulate something to make it appear genuine.

They overlap strongly.

Fabricate sounds more formal.

Important distinction 20: **fabricate vs falsify**

fabricate data

make up data that did not genuinely arise.

falsify data

alter/manipulate data or records so they become false/misleading.

A useful research/legal distinction.

AN. FABRICATION VS FICTION

fiction

openly invented imaginative writing/storytelling.

fabrication

false invention presented as truth.

Therefore:

> a novel is fiction, not normally a fabrication.

Calling someone's account:

> a fabrication

accuses them of lying.

AO. FABRICATE VS FABRIC

Do not infer:

> fabricate = make fabric.

Although related historically, modern **fabricate** usually means:

1. manufacture/build something, or
2. invent something falsely.

If you literally produce textile cloth, English usually says:

- > manufacture/produce fabric
- > weave fabric
- > knit fabric

rather than:

> *fabricate fabric*,

unless in a highly technical manufacturing context.

AP. "FABRIC" IN YOUR PASSAGE

The exact sentence is:

> Unlike shoppers in a physical boutique, our customers cannot try on a dress, **feel the fabric** or compare two sizes in front of a mirror.

The writer chooses **fabric** because online photographs can communicate:

- * colour,
- * shape,
- * design,

to some extent.

But they cannot fully communicate the tactile and physical behaviour of the textile:

- > Is it soft?
- > Is it scratchy?
- > Is it thin?
- > Does it stretch?
- > Is it stiff?
- > Does it feel cheap or substantial?
- > Does it drape naturally?

That uncertainty is part of Chris's argument that:

online customers bear more pre-purchase risk than shoppers in a physical boutique.

Therefore a total no-exchange/no-refund rule may be:

- > **disproportionately strict.**

Family-extension note

The **fabric** family has several major modern branches:

1. **clothing/textile material**

- * feel the fabric
- * fabric type
- * fabric quality

2. **fibre information**

- * fabric composition
- * fabric content

3. **samples**

- * fabric sample
- * fabric swatch

4. **fabric construction**

- * woven fabric
- * knitted fabric
- * non-woven fabric

5. **fabric properties**

- * stretch
- * breathable
- * waterproof
- * lightweight

6. **fabric behaviour**

- * shrink
- * fade
- * pill
- * wrinkle

7. **care**

- * fabric care
- * fabric softener

8. **craft/manufacturing**

- * fabric dye
- * fabric paint
- * fabric glue

9. **interior textiles**

- * upholstery fabric
- * curtain fabric

10. **technical textiles**

- * performance fabric
- * technical fabric

11. **abstract structure**

- * fabric of society
- * social fabric

12. **culture/economy/institutions**

- * cultural fabric
- * economic fabric

13. **architecture/planning**

- * urban fabric
- * building fabric
- * historic fabric

14. **cosmological metaphor**

- * fabric of reality
- * fabric of spacetime

15. **geology**

- * rock fabric
- * geological fabric

16. **computing/networking**

- * network fabric
- * switching fabric
- * storage fabric

17. **enterprise data**

- * data fabric

18. **manufacturing relative**

- * fabricate
- * fabrication
- * fabricator

19. **falsehood relative**

* fabricate evidence

* a fabrication

20. **prefabrication**

* prefabricated building

* prefab components

For your passage, the exact branch is:

fabric = the textile material from which the garment is made, especially its physical and tactile qualities that an online shopper cannot personally inspect before purchase

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea
-----	-----	-----
fabric	布料；織物	passage sense
feel the fabric	感受 / 觸摸布料	passage
a fabric	一種布料	countable type
fabrics	不同種類布料	textile types
fabric type	布料種類	classification
fabric composition	布料成分	fibres
fabric content	布料纖維成分	labelling
fabric quality	布料品質	quality
fabric choice	布料選擇	design
fabric sample	布料樣本	sample
fabric swatch	布辦 / 布樣	sample
roll of fabric	一卷布	quantity
natural fabric	天然布料	material
synthetic fabric	合成布料	material
cotton fabric	棉布	material
wool fabric	羊毛布料	material
silk fabric	絲質布料	material
linen fabric	麻布	material
woven fabric	梭織布	construction
knitted fabric	針織布	construction
non-woven fabric	不織布	construction
stretch fabric	彈性布料	property
breathable fabric	透氣布料	property
waterproof fabric	防水布料	property
water-resistant fabric	抗水 / 防潑水布料	property
lightweight fabric	輕薄布料	weight

heavyweight fabric	厚重布料	weight	
fabric weight	布重	specification	
fabric width	布幅	specification	
fabric shrinks	布料縮水	behaviour	
fabric stretches	布料拉伸	behaviour	
fabric fades	布料褪色	behaviour	
fabric pilling	布料起毛粒	wear	
fabric care	布料護理	care	
fabric care label	護理標籤	garment care	
fabric softener	衣物柔順劑	laundry	
fabric conditioner	衣物柔順劑	laundry	
fabric dye	布料染料	craft	
fabric paint	布料顏料	craft	
fabric glue	布藝膠	craft	
fabric scissors	裁布剪	sewing	
upholstery fabric	家具布	interiors	
technical fabric	技術 / 功能布料	industry	
performance fabric	功能性布料	sportswear	
recycled fabric	再生布料	sustainability	
fabric (structure)	結構 ; 組織	metaphor	
fabric of society	社會結構	society	
social fabric	社會肌理 / 結構	society	
cultural fabric	文化肌理	culture	
economic fabric	經濟結構	economy	
institutional fabric	制度結構	institutions	
urban fabric	城市肌理	planning	
building fabric	建築物本體 / 圍護結構	architecture	
historic fabric	歷史建築原有實體	conservation	
fabric of reality	現實結構	metaphor	
fabric of spacetime	時空結構	physics metaphor	
rock fabric	岩石組構	geology	
network fabric	網絡互連架構	computing	
switching fabric	交換架構	networking	
storage fabric	儲存網絡架構	computing	
data fabric	數據整合架構	enterprise IT	
computing fabric	運算互連架構	computing	
fabricate (manufacture)	製造 ; 加工	manufacturing	
fabricated component	加工構件	manufacturing	
fabrication	製造 ; 加工	manufacturing	
metal fabrication	金屬加工	manufacturing	
digital fabrication	數碼製造	manufacturing	
fabricate a story	捏造故事	falsehood	
fabricate evidence	捏造證據	falsehood	
fabricated claim	捏造主張	falsehood	
a fabrication	捏造的故事 / 謊言	falsehood	
fabricator	加工商 / 捏造者	person/company	

prefabricate	預製	manufacturing	
prefabricated	預製的	construction	
prefabrication	預製工法	construction	
prefab	預製式的 / 預製建築	informal	

For your original sentence

> Unlike shoppers in a physical boutique, our customers cannot try on a dress, **feel the fabric** or compare two sizes in front of a mirror.

Here:

fabric = 衣服實際使用的布料，以及顧客觸摸時能感受到的柔軟度、厚薄、彈性、垂墜感等物理特質

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 與在實體精品店購物的顧客不同，我們的網上顧客不能試穿裙子、**親手觸摸並感受布料**，或在鏡子前比較兩個尺碼。

The cleanest learner contrast is:

> **fabric** = 實際的布料 / 織物
 > **material** = 更廣義的材料，fabric 只是其中一類
 > **textile** = 較技術 / 產業性的「紡織品」概念
 > **cloth** = 日常「布」，但有些搭配不同
 > **fibre** = 構成布料的纖維
 > **yarn** = 編織 / 針織用的紗線
 > **texture** = 布料摸起來 / 看起來的質感
 > **composition** = 布料由甚麼纖維構成
 > **garment** = 已做好的衣物

And the biggest polysemy leap is:

> **soft fabric** = 柔軟布料
 > **social fabric** = 社會結構
 > **urban fabric** = 城市肌理
 > **building fabric** = 建築物本體 / 物理構造
 > **network fabric** = 網絡互連架構
 > **data fabric** = 數據整合架構
 > **fabrication** = 製造；也可以是**捏造**

So the common metaphorical idea behind many branches is beautifully consistent:

many individual elements are woven together into one connected whole.